The execution contract.

One page that says what an agent needs to know to act, and what a manager needs to read to understand what has been delegated. Eight fields are enough.

FIELD	THE QUESTION THAT FILLS IT	YOUR ANSWER
Trigger The precise event that starts the process	What does the agent start on—and what does it not start on?	
Inputs The data and systems the agent reads	Where does it read from, with what rights, and what does it do if an input is missing?	
Rules The explicit rules—including those never written down before	What rules does the team apply without saying so?	
Trade-offs What prevails when two rules conflict: speed, cost, quality, risk	What do you do when the customer is pushing and compliance is pushing back?	
Exceptions What falls outside the mandate, and who it escalates to	Which cases does the agent escalate, to whom, and how fast?	
Completion and quality The criterion that says the task is done, and the expected standard	How do you recognize a case that is closed—and closed well?	
Owner The person who answers for the process and the agent	Who signs, who corrects, who stops it?	
Log What is recorded, where, and for whom	What can be reviewed a month from now, and who will know how to read it?	

One page, no more. A contract that runs longer usually bundles several processes, or else you are trying to squeeze into it the judgment the mandate should leave to a human. The "Rules" field is the shortest in the first draft and the longest in the third. That is normal.

Filled-in example.

The troubleshooting agent for a home-appliance repair service, from diagnosis to booking the technician.

FIELD	WHAT THE CONTRACT SAYS
Trigger	A customer reports a broken appliance listed in the product database. The agent does not start on a complaint, a refund, or a case an advisor has already opened.
Inputs	Customer record, warranty, diagnostic trees: read access. Technicians' calendar and parts inventory: booking access. No access to payment methods.
Rules	Diagnose before booking—a third of breakdowns can be resolved remotely. Out of warranty, quote the flat fee and get the customer's agreement before any appointment. And the rule nobody had written down: a broken freezer goes to the front of the line, within forty-eight hours—the customer is losing food.
Trade-offs	Safety comes first: for a burning smell or a leak near an outlet, have the customer unplug the appliance and transfer the call. Then first-contact resolution takes priority over call duration. Never deny a warranty claim without human validation.
Exceptions	Transfer to an advisor in under two minutes: third breakdown of the same appliance, disputed warranty, an angry customer or one who asks for a human, inconclusive diagnosis after two attempts.
Completion and quality	Breakdown resolved and confirmed by the customer, or appointment confirmed in writing with the part reserved. Closed well: no callback within seven days, and the technician finds the fault as diagnosed.
Owner	The contact-center manager signs off and answers for the results. The supervisor on duty makes corrections and can stop the agent with a single action: calls are routed back to the advisors.
Log	Per case: reason, steps followed, rule applied, decision, cost, reason for escalation. Every takeover is logged with its reason—that is what rewrites the rules.